

23PR00147 Estate of Matthew Raymond Jewell

County: sonoma

Division: Probate

Hearing date: 2026-09-24

Motion: Request to Withdraw Funds from Blocked Account

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Estate of Matthew Raymond Jewell

23PR00147

Request to Withdraw Funds from Blocked Account

Tentative Ruling: The request is GRANTED. The Court will sign the proposed order lodged on August 18, 2026 with modifications as discussed below.

The Court finds that the requested rates for counsel Raposo and the certified law clerk are excessive for the Sonoma County locality. (PLCM Group, Inc. v. Drexler (2000) 22 Cal.4th 1084, 1095 [“The reasonable hourly rate is that prevailing in the community for similar work.”]; Nichols v. City of Taft (2007) 155 Cal.App.4th 1233, 1242–1243 [the relevant “community” is where the court is located].) In compliance with the Court’s knowledge of local rates in its community, the Court finds that \$250 per hour is reasonable for a certified law clerk and \$450 per hour is reasonable for counsel Raposo based on her level of experience. Therefore, the total amount of attorney’s fees granted is \$1,190.00. Any remaining funds from the \$56,500.00 withdrawal shall be redeposited into the Blocked Account no later than 30 days after all payments are made.